

EL IMPERATIVO (VOSOTROS)

Affirmative commands ending in -d · ¡Tened! ¡Pasad! ¡Venid! · Castilian Spain only

01 What these -d forms actually are

The form: ¡Tened!, ¡Pasad!, ¡Venid! are the affirmative imperative for vosotros, the way you give an order or instruction to a group of people you address informally (mates, family, kids, classmates).

One single rule: take the infinitive, drop the final -r, add -d. hablar to hablad, comer to comed, vivir to vivid. No exceptions, ever.

Spain only: vosotros is Castilian. In Latin America this form does not exist; they use ustedes (mirad becomes miren). In Spain you hear these every day.

Affirmative only: the -d ending is ONLY for positive commands. A negative command changes completely (see section 04).

02 How to form it: drop -r, add -d

Infinitive	Drop -r	Add -d	Meaning of the command
hablar	habla-	hablad	Speak! / Talk!
comer	come-	comed	Eat!
vivir	vivi-	vivid	Live!
tener	tene-	tened	Have / hold (this)!
pasar	pasa-	pasad	Come in! / Pass!
venir	veni-	venid	Come!
decir	decí-	decid	Say / tell!
hacer	hace-	haced	Do / make!
ir	i-	id	Go! (yes, just 'id')
ser	se-	sed	Be! (sed buenos = be good)

Why no irregulars: the famous tú irregulars (ten, ven, di, haz, pon, sal, sé, ve) do NOT exist in vosotros. Where tú breaks the rules, vosotros stays perfectly regular: tened, venid, decid, haced, poned, salid, sed, id.

03 When and with whom you use it

Situation	Example	Who you're talking to
Teacher to a class	Abrid los libros por la página diez.	A group, informal
Parent to children	Lavaos las manos y sentaos.	Plural, familiar
Host to guests	Pasad, pasad. Poneos cómodos.	Friends arriving
Mate to a group	Esperad, que ya voy.	Peers
Encouragement	¡Venga, chicos, corred!	A team / friends

Formal plural instead: if you address the group formally (ustedes) you do NOT use -d. You use the subjunctive: tengan, pasen, vengan, digan.

04 The big trap: negatives are totally different

Key rule: the -d ending exists ONLY in the affirmative. To say 'do NOT do it', switch to the present subjunctive vosotros (-éis / -áis). No -d anywhere.

Verb	Affirmative (do it)	Negative (don't)	Note
hablar	hablad	no habléis	-ar to -éis
comer	comed	no comáis	-er to -áis
vivir	vivid	no viváis	-ir to -áis
tener	tened	no tengáis	irregular stem
venir	venid	no vengáis	irregular stem
irse	idos / iros	no os vayáis	pronoun moves front

05 tú vs vosotros side by side

Verb	tú (one person)	vosotros (the group)	English
mirar	mira	mirad	Look!
tener	ten	tened	Hold / have!
venir	ven	venid	Come!
decir	di	decid	Say / tell!
hacer	haz	haced	Do / make!
poner	pon	poned	Put!
salir	sal	salid	Leave / go out!
ir	ve	id	Go!

06 Reflexive verbs: the -d disappears, add -os

The rule: with a reflexive verb the -os pronoun attaches to the end and the -d drops before it. levantad + os to levantaos (never 'levantados').

-ir verbs take an accent: second/third conjugation reflexives keep stress with a written accent on the i: vestíos, subíos, divertíos, reíos.

The one exception: irse keeps its consonant: idos. In everyday Spain almost everyone says iros, and the RAE now accepts it too.

Reflexive verb	Step	Command	English
sentarse	sentad + os	sentaos	Sit down!
levantarse	levantad + os	levantaos	Get up!
callarse	callad + os	callaos	Be quiet!

Reflexive verb	Step	Command	English
ponerse	poned + os	poneos	Put on / get comfortable!
vestirse	vestid + os	vestíos	Get dressed! (accent)
darse prisa	dad + os	daos prisa	Hurry up!
irse	id + os	idos / iros	Go away! / leave!

07 Adding object pronouns (and the accent it triggers)

They attach to the end: object pronouns join onto the affirmative command as one word: tenedlo, decidme, dádsele.

Watch the accent: when the extra pronoun pushes stress three or more syllables from the end, write an accent to keep the original stress: pasad to pasádmelo, dad to dádmelo.

Base command	+ pronoun(s)	Result	English
tened	+ lo	tenedlo	Hold it! (no accent needed)
decid	+ me	decidme	Tell me!
dad	+ me + lo	dádmelo	Give it to me!
pasad	+ me + lo	pasádmelo	Pass it to me!
comprad	+ se + lo	comprádselo	Buy it for him/her!

08 The ones you'll actually hear in Spain

Command	English	Typical context
¡Venid!	Come (here)!	Calling a group over
¡Mirad!	Look!	Pointing something out
¡Escuchad!	Listen!	Getting attention
¡Esperad!	Wait!	Hang on a second
¡Pasad!	Come in!	Welcoming people in
¡Tened!	Here / take this!	Handing things over
¡Sentaos!	Sit down!	Settling a group
¡Callaos!	Be quiet!	Quieting people down
¡Daos prisa!	Hurry up!	Running late
¡Tened cuidado!	Be careful!	Warning a group
¡Venga, corred!	Come on, run!	Encouragement

09 Pronunciation and the street reality

The -d is soft: in normal speech the final -d is barely pronounced, somewhere between a soft 'th' and nothing. ¡Mirad! sounds close to 'mira(d)'.

The common mistake: many native speakers replace the command with the plain infinitive: ¡Venir aquí! or ¡Callaros! instead of ¡Venid! / ¡Callaos!. You hear it constantly, but it is technically incorrect.

Reflexive in the wild: iros (for idos) and sentaros (for sentaos) are everywhere in casual Spain. iros is now officially accepted; sentaros is not.

10 30-second cheat box

Make it: infinitive minus -r plus -d. Always. (hablar to hablad)

Use it: informal order to a group, in Spain.

Negative: drop the -d, use subjunctive: no habléis, no tengáis.

Reflexive: drop the -d, add -os: sentaos, callaos. (-ir verbs: accent, vestíos.)

Only exception: irse to idos (or the now-accepted iros).

Pronouns: stick on the end; add an accent if the stress shifts: dádmelo.